Michael "Fitz" Fitzgerald

UX & Front-end Specialist

I'm a UX and front-end specialist who designs with code in mind and codes with design in mind. I've built government systems, mobile apps, and quirky side projects from job portals to role-playing game (RPG) generators. My work spans UX shaped from fuzzy requirements, front-end builds, graphics, accessibility testing, client presentations, and the pragmatic thinking that keeps projects moving. Lately I've been exploring AI-assisted coding and design to expand and speed up delivery without cutting corners.

Areas of Expertise

UX & UI Design • Interaction Design • User Research • Wireframing • Prototyping • Usability Testing • Front-End Development • Responsive Web Design • Accessibility (508 Standards) • Agile & Scrum Workflows • Design-to-Development Handoff • Visual & Graphic Design • Information Architecture • Communication, Client Presentation & Team Leadership • Technical Writing • AI-Assisted Design & Development

Technical Skills

- **Design:** Figma, Axure, Sketch, Photoshop, Illustrator
- **Front-End:** HTML, CSS, SASS, JavaScript, React, Angular
- **Other:** 508 Accessibility Standards, Git, Jira, Bitbucket, WordPress, Midjourney, Cursor

Professional Experience

Independent UX / Front-End Specialist — 2025–Present

- **Squirl!** – Hired to shepherd a company's mobile social media app from rough Replit prototype to a launchable product. Work included extensive UX reworking, code revamping, and graphics. *Tools: Figma, Replit, ReactJS, SASS, Photoshop, Illustrator*
- **Backstoryr** – First stab at agentic AI to generate tabletop RPG character backstories using old-school random tables fed into modern LLMs. *Tools: ReactJS, xAI, WordPress, Photoshop, Illustrator*
- **urAtlas Odyssey** – Designed and built a custom accountability system for a group of life coaches with dashboards, check-ins, momentum scores and a flexible architecture that could scale for coaches or solo users. Handled everything: UX, UI, data modeling, Firebase authentication, and the backend architecture (with, ahem, some AI help). *Tools: ReactJS, SQLite, Express, Firebase Auth, Cursor, Tawk, Photoshop, Illustrator*
- **QuestRex Character Generator** – Personal project designing and developing a complex React-based WordPress plugin to generate dynamic tabletop RPG characters. Crafted the UX and built the front-end with React.js and SASS. *Tools: ReactJS, SASS, WordPress, Photoshop, Illustrator*

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Publicis Sapient — Senior UX / Front-End Developer — 2013–2024

- **Consumer Product Safety Commission (CPSC)** – Worked with a team to hammer poorly defined internal processes into a sleek, reliable React app. Work included wireframes, client presentations, React development, 508 accessibility testing, and a few logos. *Tools: Axure, ReactJS, SASS, Photoshop, Illustrator, Accessibility Standards*
- **HRSA Health Workforce Connector** – Spearheaded a large multi-site initiative for HRSA. Started as an Angular developer, later shifted to designing UX patterns and component libraries used across multiple sites. Multiple rewrites as Angular matured (we began on Angular Beta) made it a rough but very fast education. *Tools: Axure, Angular, CSS, SASS, Photoshop, Illustrator, Accessibility Standards*
- **PenFed Credit Union** – Worked on a team building a mobile banking app. I led styling and CSS, making sure the app looked consistent across platforms, operating systems, and cranky old phones. *Tools: Hybrid Mobile Frameworks (PhoneGap), HTML, CSS, JavaScript*

DST / SDSE — Lead UX & Senior Front-End Developer — 2008–2011

- **Dept. of Energy HR Website** – Led the redesign of a federal HR portal, wrangling a roomful of stakeholders into consensus and producing a clean, accessible static site. Work included front-end coding, accessibility compliance, and design sign-offs. *Tools: HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Accessibility*

Additional Experience

Consulting & Web Development – Manila Consulting, Z-Tech, NGIT, and Avian Website Design. Projects included educational sites, nonprofit and government contracts (SAMHSA, NREPP, Census Bureau, etc.), and custom small-business work. *Tools: HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Graphics, PHP, ColdFusion, WebMerge, QuickTime, Flash, Shockwave (all the vintage, now extinct dev tools)*

Private Investigator – Field work including research, shadowing, and interviewing. *Tools: cameras, binoculars, but no fedora or trench coat (sadly)*

Education & Misc.

- **Education:** BA, Communications - Old Dominion University
- **Citizenship:** U.S. Citizen, Have held multiple public trusts
- **References:** Available upon request.

I design things that can be built and build things as they were designed.

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